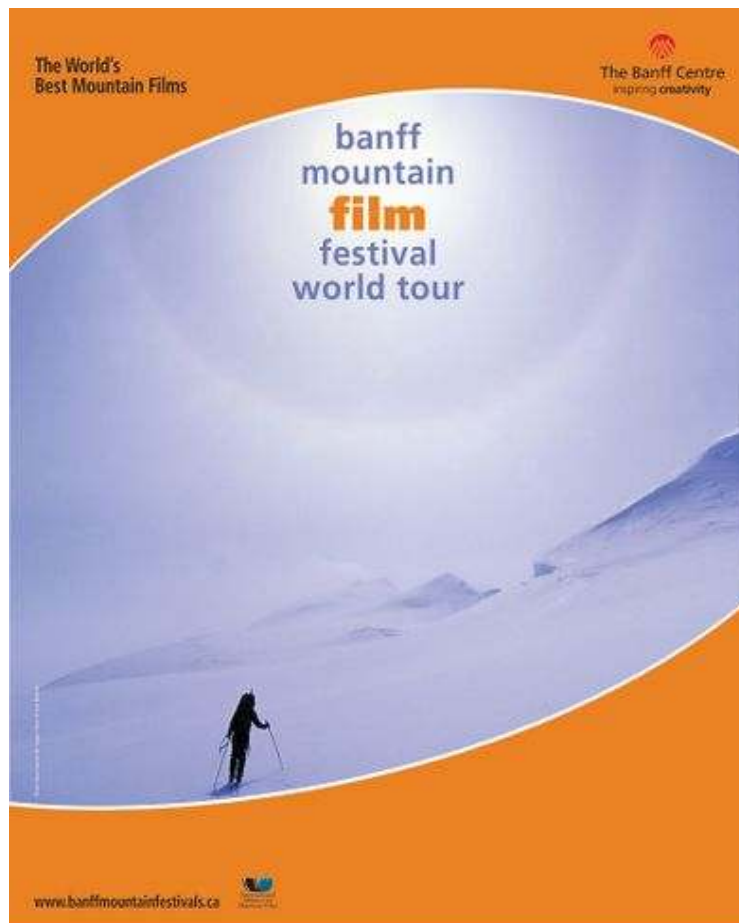


VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 727 April 2010 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Banff 2010: Wellington, 27 & 29 April

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 12 April 2010

'Why aren't climbers doing new routes these days?' by Paul Hersey

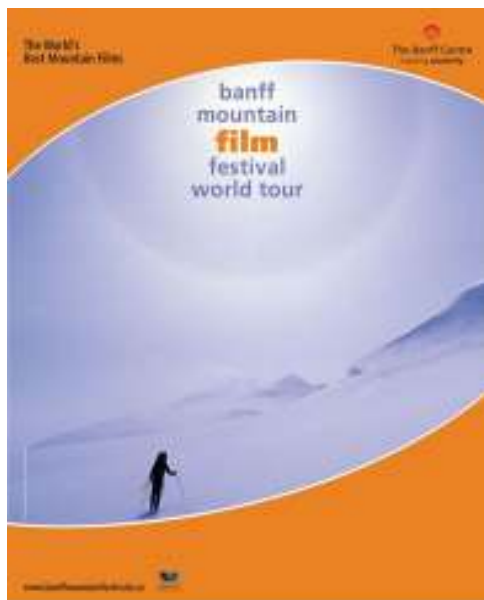
This will be an interesting discourse by Paul Hersey that may lead onto other topics and an open discussion with members from the floor.



The first ascent of the North Ridge of Mt Hopkins by Paul Hersey

Wellington section photo competition – June section night

The June section night will see the return of the NZAC Wellington section's annual photo competition. Details of how to submit photos will be published in upcoming issues of Vertigo.



Banff Mountain Film Festival 2010

Wellington screenings:

Tuesday 27 & Thursday 29 April
The Paramount Cinema, 25 Courtney
Place, at 6:30 pm

Tickets available from The Paramount
or the April section night
\$15 NZAC members, \$20 non-members

Preview:

www.banffcentre.ca/MountainCulture/Tour/

Tuesday 27 April at 6:30pm: Winter



Medeo: Filmed in the Mont Blanc range this features climbing, skiing, snowboarding, speed riding, paragliding and BASE jumping. A photographer wants to take one shot showing all the sports.

Birdman of the Karakoram: Experience the world of extreme-altitude paragliding in a remote and hypoxic world of snow, ice and previously unexplored terrain.

Hack Your Shackles: Introducing... NoBoarding. Exactly like snowboarding, but with no bindings. You get a rope and a rubber stomp pad. Hack your Shackles updates the rapid progression of this young sport.

African Revolutions Tour: From the crocodile-infested White Nile in Uganda to big-water first descents in Madagascar, a group of friends seek adventure on African rivers.

Signatures: Canvas of Snow: In Japan there is a sense that the rhythm of the seasons influences the rhythm of the person, their riding style, and the lines they choose.

Hunlen: Climbing on one of the biggest waterfalls in Canada – even if it isn't completely frozen.

Tuesday 27 April at 6:30pm: Summer



Project Megawoosh: A German engineer, works to perfect the world's tallest human water slide. Special Jury Mention.

Take a Seat: Dominic Gill's mission is to cycle the 32,000 kilometres from the northern coast of Alaska to the southern tip of South America, on a tandem bike, picking up random strangers on the way. A gripping tale of two years and two continents, full of extraordinary characters and incidents. Special Jury Mention.

Alone on the Wall: After gaining renown for his landmark free-solo of Moonlight Buttress in Zion National Park, Alex Honnold moves on to his next big challenge: free-soloing the Regular Northwest Face on Half Dome.

Revolution One: A look into the history, people, and places that have defined off-road unicycling.

Progression: World Cup: Patxi Usobiaga (Spain) and Johanna Ernst (Austria) train like Olympians to become champions of the World Cup competition circuit.

To The Rainbow: Paul Pritchard was one of Britain's most talented and outrageous climbers in the late 1980s. A head injury received while climbing the Totem Pole in Tasmania left Paul with hemiplegia. Now, 13 years on, he makes an emotional return to climbing on The Rainbow in North Wales.

Kranked: Revolve: Cycling cinematic glory from the French Alps to the lush coast of BC, incorporating dirt jump, trail, freeride, slopestyle, and downhill. Winner of the People's Choice Award for Radical Reels.

Walk of Life: The biggest and most difficult challenge of James Pearson's life - a vast blank slab on the Devon sea cliffs. This beautiful but terrifying line takes over his life until finally, sick with nerves and fear, he is ready for this scary lead. Winner of the Alpine Club of Canada Award for Best Film on Climbing.





TRIP REPORTS

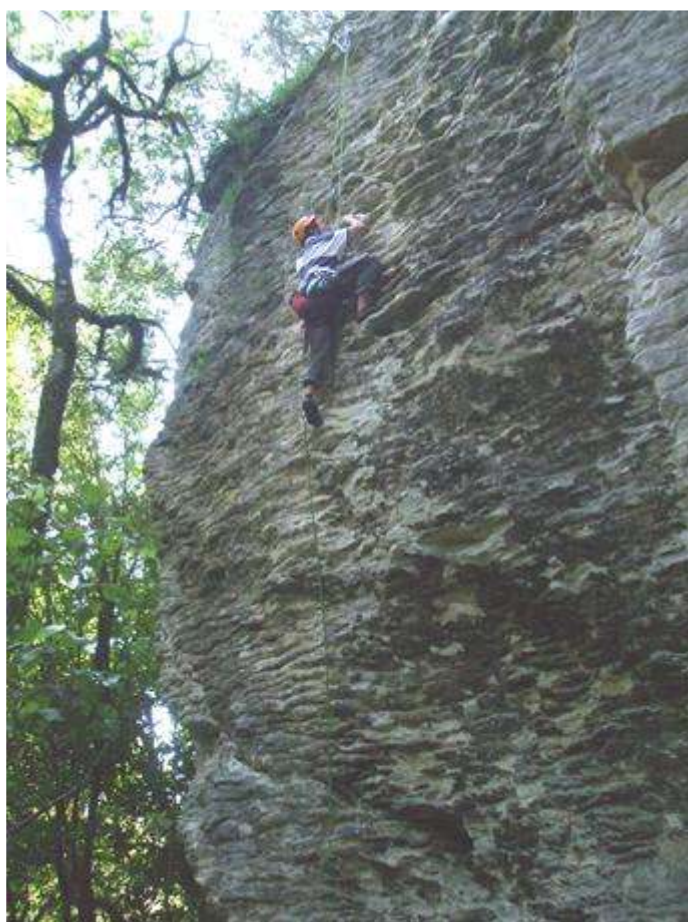
Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Mangaokewa: 27-28 February

This was my third trip to Mangaokewa this summer, which probably tells you something about the quality of the climbing given that it's a six hour drive from Wellington to the crag (just out of Te Kuiti). This weekend was the first official Wellington Section trip to Mangaokewa - ShiChang Hou, Ralf Schwoerer, Brad Markle, Marcus Manning, Clark Alston, and Steve Minchin headed up to climb on quality limestone and meet the locals.



Ralf cruises up No Kitty Bad Kitty, one of the three routes at Mangaokewa which aren't overhanging



ShiChang on The Pretender, after Ralf pulled off a key hold

I've written one report on the crag already this summer (see the March issue of Vertigo) so I won't ramble too much. We all continue to have a blast at the crag, enjoying its fingertip-friendly rock, great weather, and fun lines. I think it's safe to say that everyone I know who's climbed at Mangaokewa has come away with some projects filed away for next year. As well as this we've all broken off a few pieces of rock, large and small, so

watch out and do wear a helmet. Challenging lines are easy to find, though nice Sunday morning warm-up routes are sometimes lacking!

Saturday night at the crag campground saw our group warmly welcomed by a group of locals who were keen to share a beer, marry off their sisters (!), and tell us about the history of the area. Apparently the local tribe sent their young men up the cliffs to test their manhood - if they made it to the top they could call themselves warriors.

Harder men than me, I reckon... Despite clipping bolts every six feet, I was still whimpering on my way up Angry American the next morning.

Steve



Brad heads for glory on Votive

Argentina December 2009

Three of us (Brett, Craig & myself) traveled to Argentina; Craig & I went for the Aconcagua, Brett went to southern Patagonia and the Atacama Desert in Chile.

We had a nice introduction into Argentinean culture & lifestyle with a nightclub next to the hotel operating till 8am, fantastic food & wines, charming neighbourhoods and a concert of Manu Chao in Buenos Aires. Two days later we arrived safely with all our 46 kg each (and 6 kg of cheese) in Mendoza. Our packs were enormous and made us sweat heavily in the already 35°C. We could see the Andes and the enormous and extremely impressive Aconcagua from the airplane, which made me very quiet. We were lucky to have refuge at the house of a Wellingtonian friend who was visiting her family for the holiday season. Our final expedition preparations were combined with city tours, show dances and the undeniably fantastic asado (barbecue).

After three days in Mendoza we took the 6am bus to Los Penitentes, only 15km from the park entrance. Los Penitentes is the most ugly ski resort I have ever seen, but it provides a good starting point for some extra training. We had a short training of only three days with sleeping and walking at a higher level every day.



The top of Los Penitentes

Good time to find out that your stove needs a new pump (thanks Pete) and finding out that you brought a generic MSR pump which fits every MSR stove, except the MSR Dragonfly you were carrying. At moments like these you really appreciate traveling with

someone who is technical and able to fix this without losing time and altitude fitness by traveling back to Mendoza.

Day 1, 6th of December we entered the Aconcagua Park by Horcones (we decided to go for the Normal route only two days before). We felt extremely fit when arriving at the first campsite three hours later. Confluencia is 'only' at 3300m. This gave us time to have an extra walk in the afternoon, to get more altitude in the system. The following day after a satisfying medical exam we were warned (again) for altitude sickness and recommended to have at least five liters of liquid a day. Considering it was not cold beer we were drinking, we had to remind each other to have another sip to avoid the symptoms of altitude sickness.

Day 2 brought us to base camp Plaza de Mulas at 4260m. The walk is very scenic and misleading as the first six hours you only climb about 300m. In the last two to three hours you ascend another 660m. This last bit made me remind how altitude sickness feels and that you should carry plenty of water for the last bit. But this was quickly resolved by replenishing with tea and a "Quick" brand cup-a-soup (which we renamed as you can imagine). The following day our results from the medical exam were not as great as the day before but this was to be expected. It was also our rest day, so we took stock of all the food and gear the mules carried for us. Absolutely worth all U\$120. We also paid the highest hotel in the southern hemisphere a visit, which was being prepared for the high season.



View from the tent on Camp Canada

On Day 3 we walked 700m to do our first food cache at Campamento Canada. We met other climbers from Europe and started putting names to faces. We meet the Mammut team – four strong and fit guys from Slovakia, all recognizable by their bright orange gear. Their trip leader was a veteran climber as he conquered Aconcagua seven times already

and happily kept on smoking. Another guy was a Scot, who was completely oblivious of what is actually fashionable in climbing land, ascending alone in his is Famous Grouse cotton rugby shirt with matching hat and a jacket that had not been waterproof for years. He was someone in his 60s so had lots of interesting climbing/life stories to tell. His red lipstick fascinated us, but we did not dare to ask why it was not colourless lip balm.

I felt sick again from the altitude but managed to linger for an hour at the campsite before we descend back to base camp. My appetite was still ok, although those dried fruit salads we were having were not getting more interesting. Back at base we treated ourselves to a nice cheese platter and a Quicky (I know ...) to celebrate our first cache.

Day 4 another rest day. Just socialising with the people that were working at base camp with having teas and mate (not recommended!) and sopaipillas, which is some fried dough with sprinkled sugar, similar to churros (yes, recommended). It helps to speak the language as it opens up a lot of doors and you have the camp gossip nearly first hand. Craig carried on reading his book. I had another medical check and decided my test results were satisfying enough to continue. But at the medical clinic I saw one of the Mammot team members with an oxygen mask, not allowed to lie down. The trip the day before was apparently too much.



Always smile, even if you feel like sh*t

Day 5 we packed up late, as we knew the walk only takes about three to four hours. The sun hit base camp around 9.30am so it was really cold to get out of the tent before. Water froze overnight, so it pays to get your breakfast water sorted the night before. Toilets were near our tents, so we also met an English bloke from the one-pole tent passing our tents every hour. The way he was speaking you could tell he was not completely sure of why he was going to the bathroom that often. Hopefully he was going take his rests too.

Back at Camp Canada we found a nice tent site overlooking the whole camp. Even though the tracks up the mountain were nearly all clean from the snow, there was still enough snow around for cooking. I felt sick again and Craig took care of setting up the tent, collecting snow and making tea. It's a blessing to be climbing with a partner who experienced altitude sickness himself on other mountains. I felt sick before in La Paz and Cusco on previous travels, but never this severe. Altitude sickness feels like an extremely serious hangover that is refusing to disappear. Every little pebble you kick accidentally with the front of your boot creates a serious hammer effect in your brain.

We observed other climbers who got completely pampered by mountain hosts with water, food, lunch packets and toilet tent! Our jaws nearly hit the ground when the following morning the tents got packed by their hosts and some so called climbers just have an ordinary weekend bag that was taken care of by a porter. It is another way of climbing the mountain, that's for sure. We had another rest day and I was slowly feeling better from my altitude sickness.

On Day 6 we were woken up by the Mammot team (down to three now). One of the remaining fit looking men was in pain and on the ground near our tent. The trip leader barked everyone to keep his or her distance as nobody was a certified doctor, but everyone was willing to help. What could you do? Diamox was not the answer and we wanted to keep these tablets to ourselves for later. The pains this man was having, were not identical to the ones caused by altitude sickness any way. The Mammot team decided to turn around for base camp. We spent the rest of the day discussing our books, drinking lots of tea and observing the other climbers. I started to feel better and optimistic again.



It is worth getting up a bit higher

Day 7 we aimed for Campamento Nido de Condores 5250m. This should be an easy walk as it's only 300m higher than Canada. We prepared for another cache and slowly made our way up. Within an hour I felt sick again. Even two strong Nurofens did the job for only two minutes. I tried to keep the spirit alive and was hearing The Don saying in my head: Climbing a mountain is just putting one foot in front of the other. It still sounds so simple. At the same time I had also an angel on each shoulder. One angel with a list of why I was still climbing the mountain and aiming for the 360° views. The other one with a list of things I could do in Argentina and Chile in the 2.5 weeks I had left. The latter was getting more and more boisterous. Only 100m before Nido de Condores I decided to turn around and listen to angel nr 2. After Nido de Condores there was still Campamento Berlin at 5900m.

The previous days Craig and I talked a lot and we both did not think it was becoming realistic for me to do a climb over 1000m on summit day. So why bother climbing up to the other camp sites when altitude sickness hits you every time you feel good and attempt to go higher? I handed over my food cache to Craig and headed back to Canada, where I immediately felt better and had a talk in my rusty French with our neighbours from Bordeaux. But we managed to get along very well and they nearly convinced me to keep on trying to continue, but at a slower pace. That night Craig and I talked about it again and I decided to stick to my decision. Time for some last pictures of us together and then back down the following day.

I walked out of the park in two days. Craig stayed 5 more days and had a serious attempt on the summit. But he had to turn around, as the wind was too strong and cold to continue. The weather forecast was similar for the next 5 days so he came down too. The entertainment options became sparse and he didn't feel like reading his book for the 3rd time.

The mountain trip was a very interesting and enjoyable one. I am glad we did what we did and don't regret all the training and prep work at all. The tracks are really easy till Nido but once you are up high you really need entertainment for the non-walking moments to stay relaxed as the wind keeps on trying to blow your tent away from under your body. The one-pole tent guy also made it to Nido but he never made a mentally healthy impression. People like him do not realise what they are attempting to climb and literally walk into their own death. But we did also see enough people with guides being mentally pushed up the mountain and falling severely sick.

I met the Mammut team for the final time when I returned to base camp alone. They were down to two; only the smoking trip leader and his client who looked very unhappy and short of breath. Not sure if they ever made it to the top. When Craig arrived back at Mendoza I just returned from a short trip to friends that I had not seen for exactly 20 years (made me feel old).

Craig spent his final days traveling to the Iguazu waterfalls in northeast Argentina and I spent Christmas with Brett and my Chilean friends in Santiago. We reunited in Buenos Aires for some final shopping and loitering. It was great traveling with these guys.

A fantastic trip!

Anouk Minnaar

North ridge of Hopeless

Left Hopeless Hut at 7am, gaining ridge at col between peaks 2000 and 2085. No snow or ice. Ridge scrambling ok until pinnacle requiring 30m descent on Sabine side followed by exposed chimney (soloed). Arrived on north ridge initially on the broad saddle just north of peak 2000 approx 1pm.

We gazed down the gash and ruled out abseil; noted that the rock around gash was difficult to protect (compact yet brittle). Followed guidebook comments and carefully downclimbed ledges on Sabine side (SW) to scree below gash. From there at 2.30pm, wary of the time and committing route to regain the north ridge, we descended into Sabine via side creeks below 2085 and out.

On reflection, wonder if this section would be best climbed with a high bivvy and/or snow (for ease of climbing/water). As far as I am aware this route hasn't been climbed more than 2-3 times. Contemplating further attempts...

Scott Miller



Dave topping out of chimney



UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Arrowsmiths from the Lawrence

Date: 1-5 April 2010 (Easter weekend)

Leader: Pete Shanahan

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Chance to use some of those lazy last days of the autumn before the first of the snows come in. Walk in will be from Erewhon. The rock is better on western side of the Arrowsmith range. Friday High Camp, Saturday Summit, Sunday Spare Day, Monday Walk Out, Tuesday drive home. There exists the potential for doing a new rock route so bring your cams! Contact Pete at 934 7926 or by email at peter.shanahan@publictrust.co.nz



Whanganui Bay

Date: 23-25 April 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 16-25+

Come join us for a weekend of sport and trad climbing at Whanganui Bay. Plan is to leave Wellington after work on Friday evening and tent for 2 nights at the Bay. With over 1000 routes to choose on classic ignimbrite rock adjacent to the beautiful Lake Taupo from this is truly the Mecca of North Island rock climbing. Try yourself out on the Whakenui classics of Small Pocks (19, sport), James Stirling Direct (17, trad), and the three pitch chimney climb Tibia (16, trad). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



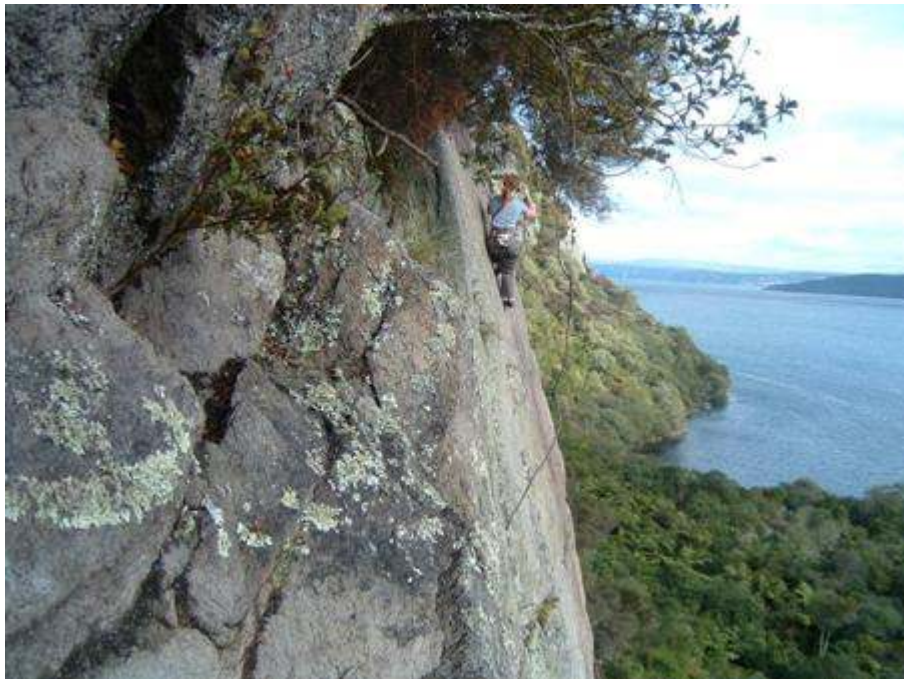
Kawakawa Bay

Date: 7-9 May 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 13-22+

Take a trip to the newly developed crags of nearby Kawakawa Bay. Come along for a weekend of sport (and some trad) climbing on some quality rock, against the backdrop of the largest lake in the North Island. Explore the large number of mid-grade climbs available including the classic 2 pitch High Hopes (16). Hone up on those rock skills with some full pitch climbs. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Kawakawa Bay



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku

Date: 4-7 June 2010 (Queen's Birthday weekend)

Leader: Waimaria Erueti

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Waimaria at 380 6277(h) or 027 289 3024 or by email at waimariaeruetti@gmail.com



Ruapehu South

Date: 9-11 July 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Taurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Taurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu Crater Lake



Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga

Date: 13-15 August 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paretetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



WELLINGTON SECTION INSTRUCTION

The Wellington Section Instruction courses have always been popular and many of our active young climbers have gained their foundation skills on courses like our Alpine Instruction Course (AIC) and "Summer Rock" courses. The section instruction program is being extended over the next few years with a number of new courses in order to provide help meet the needs of those developing their climbing skills. AIC and Summer Rock are remaining in their current and successful format, but courses like **Alpine Navigation**, **Alpine Hazard Awareness** (Avalanche), and **Alpine Trip Planning and Expedition**. These courses are supplemented by the Wellington Instructor development programme.

Alpine Navigation Course

Start 26th April to 4th May.

This course is designed to give confidence to climbers in their navigation skills. It will move through the basics quickly and concentrate on the refinements that enable you to become an expert alpine navigator. There will be a field day in the Tararuas where you'll be spending your time off tracks and relying upon your map and compass. The second evening session will concentrate on GPS, electronic maps and other modern aids. Cost \$80

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Alpine Hazards Awareness

2nd to 4th July, Whakapapa, Mt Ruapahu

This course is primarily designed to have a greater understanding of Alpine Hazards and how we can modify our behaviour in order to make our experience in the Alpine environment safer, and more enjoyable. Much of the course will be devoted to reading snow conditions and accessing avalanche risks. The course is being conducted by a professional instructor. Cost \$350

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Alpine Instruction Course

June to August. 3 Mountain weekends, a field day, plus 5 evening sessions.

This is probably the best way to be introduced to the alpine environment, learn techniques, gain some life skills, and meet potential climbing partners. The course takes you from the fundamentals of getting your gear sorted to roped climbing and emergency shelters (like snow caves). Cost \$899

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Instructor Development Program 2010

18th to 20th June, Turoa, Mt Ruapahu

Once accepted into the instructor development program the section will assist you becoming an instructor for your chosen specialty. It will provide a weekend course each year, plus subsidise you onto other courses. This years course is designed for Alpine skills Instructors. We have a qualified professional instructor for the weekend. The program provides an ideal opportunity for those who would like to develop their technical, delivery skills further, plus gives insight into group management, risk assessment and incident planning. Next year the course will be aimed for those wanting to develop their rock climbing instruction skills. We will be linking into courses run by the alpine Club, or other organisations like Mountain Safety Council. Cost TBA.

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Alpine Trip Planning and Expedition

September. (24th to 27th for Expedition)

This course consists of two evenings and a three day weekend in the mountains of the upper part of the south island. The student will be taken through the trip planning process, including "where to go climbing", research, and emergency plans, group management. The participants will then plan and participate in a three day weekend trip. The trip will have experienced climbers along who can act as mentors. An ideal follow-up for those who have completed the AIC and want to test their skills. Costs TBA

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Outdoor First-Aid

The section is not running a course this year. But if anybody wants to attend a course, we can arrange you to attend an appropriate course being run by other organisations. Next year we are planning to develop a course tailored to our members needs.

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or
email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Summer Rock

February to March

This extremely popular course will be run again next year.

Contact Blair Hiscoke 027 233 2468
Email: summerrock@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



CLASSIFIEDS



Climber magazines

Please contact Byron Skinner if you are interested in purchasing the following Climber mags: issues 15-35; 42; 48-55; 59. \$30 lot, or \$1 each (postage extra) Phone 03 354 9490



Ski Touring / Climber's Approach Ski Set Up

- Salomon Xscream 174cm (these skis have been recently tuned, waxed and ready to go). Edges, Bases and tops in first class condition – minor scratches only.
- Silveretta 404 bindings with brakes - the 404 is still the only binding compatible with ski boots / touring boots / climbing boots
- Montana skins – nylon pile in good condition, but bases now due for re-glue
- Voile USA ski crampons – these crampons, when engaged, give superior climbing ability as surface contact is maintained at all times – unlike Fritschi / Dynafit crampons which disengage with each heel lift.

Digital photos can be sent if required

\$550.00 ono for the full set

- LOWA ski touring boots size 9UK – Inners, shell / tread / buckles all in excellent order, but ski / walk levers missing – locked in ski mode, but doesn't really make too much different to walking / touring performance.

\$200.00 ono.

Contact Steve on 021 535732, or e-mail fowler_assocs@xtra.co.nz



NOTICES



Honorary Auditor

The honorary auditor for the Wellington section resigned last year after having audited their accounts for a number of years. The section would desperately like to find a replacement and ask whether any member would be willing to take on this role for the section.

Offers and enquiries would be greatly appreciated and can be directed to Catherine Moger catherinemoger@hotmail.com or Richard Davies Richard.Davies@justice.govt.nz



Bunk space Available at Ruapehu Hut and Massey Hut

The instruction courses (see page 15) have booked the whole of these huts for each weekend, but will not be filling the huts. So there are a limited number of spare bunk space which has been made available for Wellington Section Climbers. Climbers could link into the transport arrangements of the instruction groups. It'll be a good chance to get some early season ice climbing done.

Ruapehu Hut, Whakapapa

2nd to 4th July

Massey Hut, Turoa

18th to 20th June

Contact Don French 06 377 7117 or 027 445 2980 or email aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Alpine Navigation Course

Wellington Section is running an Alpine Navigation Course near the end of April / May. It consists of two evening theory sessions with a field day in between them.

Over years of experiences I have discovered that climbers are often not as good at navigation as they think they are. This is a chance to address it. You don't want to lose time trying to get to the base of your climb in the dark, or find out how to follow those excellent deer trails that the guide books often talk about. Then of course you want to get back to the hut in the storm at the end of the day.

Email or Ring me if you want to know more or register. Don French (027 445 2980, don.f@xtra.co.nz)



Cordillera Blanca

I am planning on climbing in the Cordillera Blanca (Peru) and would like to know if anyone else from the section is interested in climbing several mountains including:

- Pisco 5750m (altitude acclimatisation climb), and
- Alpamayo 5947 (arguably world's most beautiful mountain), and
- Any other mountains in the range as possible.

Email me at scottmillerinnz@yahoo.com for further details. Cheers, Scott Miller



Whanganui Bay campfires

Pete (Carmen's husband who lives in the green house where you pay at Whanganui Bay) is looking for some concrete pipe to make a permanent fire place for the camp ground - if any of you have access to some can you please get in touch with him.

Also.. in the meantime, if you are camping at the Bay and you see climbers making a new fire place so that they don't have to walk to far from their tent, please ask them to use the existing fire place. Pete has been doing an amazing job at keeping the camp ground nice for us, but he is getting a bit tired of cleaning up the new fire places that the climbers build everywhere.



New NZAC webpages

As the current NZAC Journal index only goes up to 1987, an ongoing obituary index has been created covering from 1988 until the present day. These articles have been a valuable resource not only as a memorial to our members, but as a record of their contributions to climbing in New Zealand. The page can be found under the 'History' header on the Club's website: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/history/memoriam-obituaries>

A page has also been added to list New Zealanders who have made successful ascents of Mt Everest <http://alpineclub.org.nz/history/Everest-ascents-by-New-Zealanders>



Fergs Rock and Kayaks

Over the years Fergs Rock and Kayaks have supported your organisation through cheaper climbing rates and club nights, this has been great for us and hopefully as great for your members and we intend to carry on with this support. Please note for members to receive a discounted climbing entry rate a current membership card must be shown as you are signing in otherwise there will be no discount given, this makes it fair on everybody.

Mike Osborn
Hire Manager - Fergs Kayaks Wellington



New Zealand Alpine Club Wellington Section

Distaghil Sar Award

****Applications now sought****

The Distaghil Sar Award is designed to assist members of the Wellington Section of the Alpine Club to become better qualified climbing instructors and to promote the professionalism of the club's instruction courses thereby improving the safety and pleasure of climbing generally.

The Wellington Section Committee has agreed to make up to two awards in 2010, one for alpine instruction and one for rock instruction. Each grant will be for a maximum of \$500.

Applications for the Award

Any member of the Wellington Section of the Alpine Club may apply for the award for a course from NZAC, MSC, NZOIA or any other course that the fund administrators consider appropriate.

Applications must be in writing and include the following:

- the course or qualification for which financial assistance is sought
- the need for such assistance
- the availability of the applicant to instruct on courses run by the Wellington Section

Applications should be sent to DSF administrator at PO Box 1628, Wellington or e-mailed to secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Applications close 31 May 2010

Criteria

In selecting a recipient for the award the following criteria will be considered:

- climbing skills and judgment
- ability to communicate with students
- commitment to safety
- previous contributions to Wellington Section instruction course
- availability to instruct on Wellington Section instruction course in the future

Successful applicants are required to provide a report to the fund administrators by the beginning of December in the year the course was held. Payment will be made against invoices for receipts. It is not available retrospectively.

Background

The Distaghil Sar Memorial Trust Fund was inaugurated in 1997 as a memorial to Andy Boas, Chris Hoare and Steve Thornley who died in the Karakoram Mountains in August of 1996 whilst attempting an ascent of Distaghil Sar (7,885m). In 1997 family and friends of Andy, Chris and Steve, the Wellington Section and its members made substantial donations to inaugurate the fund. A further substantial donation was made in 1999. The fund has subsequently become established as a memorial to all other Wellington Section members who have died whilst climbing.



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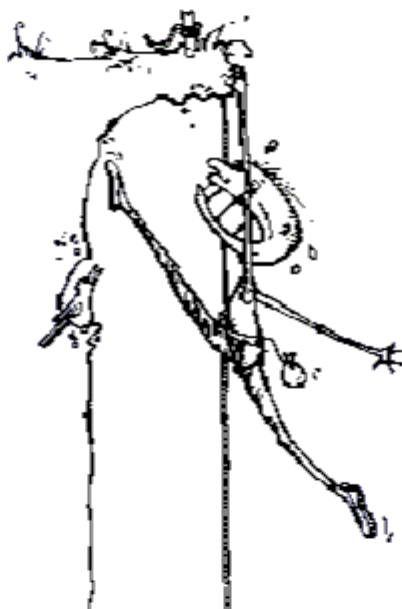
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WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Gwen Rashbrooke		
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

